Table 15.2 Differences between CodeDeploy, CloudFormation and user data, and Packer

	AWS CodeDeploy	AWS CloudFormation and user data	Packer
Deployment speed	Fast	Slow	Medium
Agility	Medium	High	Low
Advantages	In-place deployments work for stateful machines as well.	Changing the user data script is a flexible way to deploy changes.	Machines are starting really fast, which is important if you want to scale based on demand. Also, you have low risk of failures during the boot process.
Disadvantages	Changes pile up on machines, which make it difficult to reproduce a deployment.	Potential failures during the boot process exist, for example, when third parties like GitHub are down.	Handling the life cycle of AMIs is tricky because you have to clean up unused and old AMIs to avoid storage costs.

We use all three options and choose the approach that best fits a particular scenario.